

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

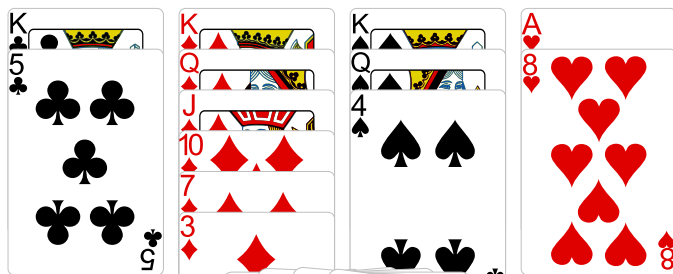
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



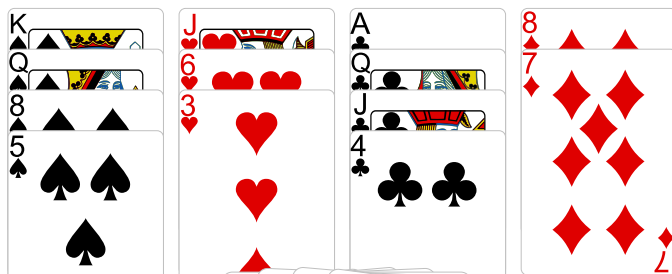
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



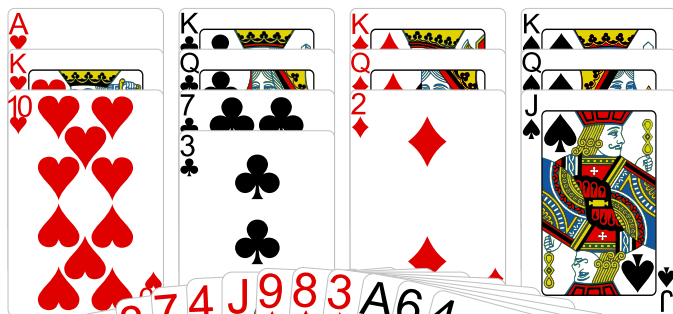
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 3 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



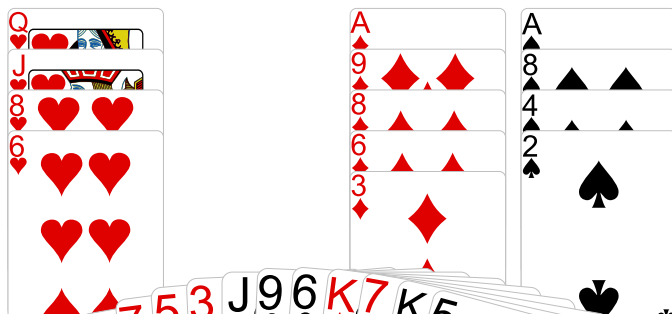
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 7♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 7♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 3
♦ 8 5 2
♣ A 4 3

13
6 3
18

♠ A 6 3
♥ K T 7
♦ A 9 4
♣ Q 9 8 7



♠ K Q 4
♥ A 8
♦ K Q J T 7 3
♣ K 5

♠ J 8 5 2
♥ J 9 4 2
♦ 6
♣ J T 6 2

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SOUTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners.

So when NORTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, SOUTH uses Gerber.

NORTH shows two Aces so SOUTH decides 6NT will be just right.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

Deal 2

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K Q 8 5
♥ J 6 3
♦ 8 7
♣ A Q J 4

3
13 19
5

♠ T 7 2
♥ T 9 7 2
♦ K T 9 5 3
♣ 7

N
W E
S

♠ 4
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 4 2
♣ T 9 8 6 3 2

♠ A J 9 6 3
♥ A 4
♦ A Q J 6
♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
3 ♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♠	Pass	5NT	Pass
6 ♣	Pass	6 ♠	
All Pass			
6 ♠ by East			

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When WEST gives immediate ♠ support,
EAST's thoughts naturally

turn to slam. This is a good hand to use
Blackwood on, so EAST bids 4NT.

WEST's 5

♦

answer shows one Ace, which EAST cleverly
deduces

must be the ♣A.

EAST bids 6 ♠ since WEST has not bid
strongly enough to think about 7.

Deal 3

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ 6
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ T 9 8 6 5 4

23
4 5
8

♠ K Q J
♥ A K T
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ -

♠ T 9 8 7 3
♥ 5 3 2
♦ T 7
♣ A J 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

NORTH bids 6



, knowing they must lose the



A.

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NORTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn,
but SOUTH gives a positive 2



response and his thinking changes! First he
supports



s, setting the

trump suit.

SOUTH then bids 3♠, showing first round
control. NORTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and

SOUTH replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and
one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

Deal 4

West Deals
Both Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K T 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

8
14 11
7

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 2
♦ Q 5 2
♣ K T 5 3 2



♠ T 7 6
♥ 9 4
♦ J T 4
♣ A Q 8 7 4

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ -

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	5NT	Pass
7♥			
All Pass			
7♥ by West			

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EAST's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card



support,

at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

WEST bids 4NT, Blackwood.

EAST's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

WEST counts thirteen tricks and bids 7



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Deal 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9 8 4
♥ 6
♦ T 7 2
♣ 8 7 5

18
7 7
8

♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J T 3
♦ A
♣ K Q T 6



♠ -
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2

♠ T 7 6 2
♥ 8 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3
♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

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NORTH figures that if SOUTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

SOUTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which

is higher-ranking than



s.

NORTH manages to figure out that SOUTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.